# DEDAN KIMATHI UNIVERSITY OF TECHNOLOGY

## IGS 4202: IGS CAPSTONE PROJECT

# Autobiography Essay for Gideon Nyakundi


**SUBMITTED BY:**

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# AUTOBIOGRAPHY

**OF GIDEON NYAKUNDI**

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# Chapter 1

## Family Background & Early Life

I was born in the quiet village of Mochorwa, located in Kenyenya Sub-county, Kisii County, within the former Nyanza Province of Kenya. It was a typical rural setup: lush and green, with hills and traditional homesteads scattered across the landscape. This is where my life began, surrounded by love, laughter, faith, and culture. I am the first-born child of my parents, John Mwambi and Sibia Moraa. Being their first child gave me a unique and cherished place in the family.

From an early age, I was enveloped in the warmth of an extended family deeply rooted in the Christian faith and cultural pride. My grandfather, Gedion Mwambi Nyasimi, played a monumental role in shaping the spiritual foundation of our family. Once entangled in alcoholism, he encountered Christ and transformed his life radically. Today, he is a respected apostle known across the Gusii region for his unwavering dedication to spreading the gospel. His prayers have been a source of healing for many, and his mastery of the Bible, from Genesis to Revelation, is a marvel to behold. To us, he is more than a patriarch; he is a spiritual giant and a man of God whose impact goes far beyond our family boundaries.

It was my grandfather who founded and built Alpha and Omega Church right on our ancestral land. His vision and commitment to the gospel gave our home a spiritual heartbeat, and his influence continues to shape our faith journey. We adore him deeply, and his legacy continues to live on in all of us.

My grandmother, Kwamboka, shared a home with Kerubo, my grandfather's co-wife. In our Ekegusii culture, grandchildren from daughters are traditionally not counted as heirs to the lineage. While Kerubo already had grandchildren through her sons, my grandmother had none until I was born. My arrival changed everything. It was a deeply emotional moment for her because I was the first grandchild born into her direct line, and it brought her both pride and joy. From that moment on, we formed a bond that could never be broken.

Growing up, I spent much of my time with my grandparents, basking in their love and protection. I didn't have many structured memories as a toddler, but I vividly remember playing with soil and mud. I would return home completely dirty, and my mother would

scold me, then bathe me, apply Valon jelly, and dress me neatly again. Often, she would tease me sarcastically by saying, "Go out and play, make sure you bathe in dust today!" We would all laugh about it, and it became a family joke.

There were times I wanted to wear a specific outfit or shoe, and if my mother refused, I would run crying to my grandparents. They would always defend me. If I had dirtied my clothes, they would tell her to spare me. If I insisted on wearing a certain pair of shoes, they would support me. To them, I wasn't just a grandchild; I was their child too.

One fond memory I carry with me is when I was about five years old. My mother had bought a goat, and she and I would take it grazing together. There is a rocky, hilly area in our village called Emanga, and climbing it was a big challenge for my little legs. My mother would often carry me or push me up the path as I clung onto the stones. These moments, though simple, were filled with love and adventure.

I was also brought up in a home where photography was valued. My father had a film camera, and he would often take pictures of me as a child. My mother, with a playful spirit, would keep changing my outfits so I could look different in each photo. It was a small thing, but it meant the world to me. It made me feel special, celebrated, and deeply loved.

Our home was full of laughter. My parents jokingly called me "Ekegondo," which means monkey in Ekegusii. It was a playful nickname given out of love, probably inspired by my active nature and constant movement as a child. It became a part of my identity in those early years and still brings a smile to my face when I hear it.

Spiritually, my journey started early. I was brought up in a Christian family, and my mother began teaching me how to pray from a very young age. Before bedtime, we would kneel and talk to God. That discipline instilled in me a personal connection with faith that I still hold on to today.

I was raised to be honest, respectful, and obedient. I remember always asking my mother for permission, even when I knew where something was. For example, we used to keep ripe bananas in a basket, and although I could have taken one on my own, I always asked. She would keep tea in a thermos on the floor where I could reach it easily. This was just one of many ways she showed love through small actions.

Because of my obedience, I was often sent on errands. Whether it was going to the only shop in the village to buy radio batteries or borrowing an axe from a neighbor, I was always trusted

to do the task and return responsibly. My elders and relatives appreciated my reliability, and that trust helped build my confidence early on.

In every sense, my early life was filled with love, tradition, structure, and faith. Those formative years in Mochorwa taught me the importance of community, spirituality, and humility. These are lessons I carry with me to this day.

# Chapter 2

# Education Journey

My educational journey began in the rural landscapes of Bomachoge Chache constituency, Kisii County, where I first attended Nyakenyerere DEB for daycare. The school sat atop the rocky Emanga hills, and getting there as a child was quite the adventure. Each morning, my mother or our neighbors would accompany me to help me climb the rocky path to school. Reaching the top wasn't always easy for my little legs; however, once I got there, someone would call out my name to confirm I had successfully made the climb. That school is where I first learned to hold a pencil, scribble shaky letters, and dream quietly of the future. I remember having only one book for all my subjects, yet in those humble beginnings, the seed of education was planted.

In 2008, a major shift occurred. My family moved to Nairobi, and I joined Green Cottage Academy located in Kahawa West. The transition from a rural school to a city-based private school was both exciting and intimidating. The new environment challenged me to adapt quickly, both socially and academically.

Later, I joined Calvary Covenant School in 2016, where I spent my final years of primary education. It was here that I really found my academic rhythm. I performed excellently in my KCPE exams in 2017, and that performance opened the doors for me to join one of the top schools in the region.

In 2018, I was admitted to the prestigious Kisii School. This is a National School known for its high standards and competitiveness. It was an incredible opportunity, but it was not without its challenges. Coming from a small primary school class of only 21 students, I suddenly found myself among over 600 Form One students spread across nine streams. It was overwhelming at first. The shift from being easily noticed by teachers to being part of a massive student population was difficult. In primary school, teachers tracked each student closely; here, you had to fight to stand out. If you dropped in performance, it was on you to realize and correct it because no one would necessarily point it out.

Boarding school life was also a new experience for me. For the first time, I had to live away from my parents and adjust to managing my own time, space, and even pocket money. Life in the dorms introduced me to structure, which included waking up very early, observing

routines, and sharing space with dozens of others. It wasn't always easy, but it helped me grow and become independent.

Then in 2020, everything came to a halt. The COVID-19 pandemic disrupted the world, and schools were closed for months. Like many students, I faced anxiety, uncertainty, and a long academic gap. Yet, this period taught me resilience and the importance of adapting even when the path ahead is unclear.

Despite the challenges, I achieved many academic and leadership milestones. In Standard 7, I was appointed Deputy Head Boy, and in Standard 8, I rose to Head Boy. This was a position that tested and refined my leadership, communication, and conflict resolution skills. In high school, I continued to serve: first as a class prefect for Forms 2 and 3, and then in various dormitory leadership roles as part of the House Committee.

These roles taught me valuable life lessons. First, I learned that success is never instant; you have to earn it. Secondly, I saw that discipline, hard work, and integrity are cornerstones of any lasting achievement. Thirdly, I realized that leadership is not about being perfect, but about serving others and learning from failure.

Academically, I faced some setbacks, especially while adjusting to the complexity of high school learning. Unlike primary school, where we handled six subjects mostly through multiple-choice tests, high school had eleven subjects. Each was demanding and featured more structured, essay-style assessments. It required a new level of commitment and self-discipline. I had to reorganize my study habits, manage my time better, and stay focused amid distractions.

Looking back, my education has not just been about grades. It has been a journey of discovering who I am, stretching my limits, failing, recovering, and realizing that learning continues far beyond the classroom. From the rocky hills of Emanga to the packed dormitories of Kisii School, every experience has been a stepping stone that shaped me into the person I am today.

# Chapter 3

# Life in University

My life at the university marked a defining chapter in my personal and professional growth. It was a period of discovery, responsibility, and clarity; specifically, it helped me understand who I am and what I want to become. Choosing Computer Science was not a sudden decision. Instead, it was the natural continuation of a love for technology that had been growing within me since childhood.

My fascination with computers began at a very young age. I was first introduced to using a computer by my uncle, James, who patiently guided me through the basics. When I was around five to seven years old, I learned how to use a keyboard and navigate a computer by playing games such as Road Rash and other educational programs. Those early experiences left a strong impression on me. What started as play slowly became curiosity, and that curiosity grew into passion.

My father further nurtured this interest by supporting me with access to a computer at home and giving me the freedom to explore it. This exposure gave me confidence and familiarity with technology at an early age. In primary school, I studied Computer Studies from Class 3 to Class 7. When I joined high school, I chose Computer Studies as my technical subject. I excelled both in theory and practicals; I consistently scored highly and stood out among my peers. These experiences confirmed to me that technology was not just something I enjoyed: it was something I was good at.

The COVID-19 pandemic in 2020, despite its many challenges, became a turning point in my technical growth. During the lockdown, I spent extended time with my laptop while experimenting and learning independently. It was during this period that I taught myself HTML and began creating simple websites. This self-driven learning gave me confidence and introduced me to the idea of building real-world solutions using code.

When I finally joined university to pursue Computer Science, I entered with excitement but also with misconceptions. Like many first-year students, I initially viewed university life as a space of total freedom: less structure, more social life, and minimal academic pressure. The reality, however, quickly set in. Some technical units were challenging and required deeper

concentration and consistency than I had anticipated. Grasping complex concepts was not always easy, and I had to unlearn the habit of last-minute studying.

Despite these early struggles, university life became a place of growth. I learned how to manage my time, handle my finances, and take responsibility for my decisions. Living independently forced me to mature quickly. I adjusted, found balance, and began to approach my studies with seriousness and discipline. Along the way, I made meaningful friendships. These were people who influenced my mindset, encouraged my ambitions, and shaped my university experience positively.

As I progressed, I became more intentional about my career path. I devoted myself to becoming a software engineer, focusing not only on passing exams but also on understanding concepts deeply and applying them practically. I embraced continuous learning beyond the classroom and sought opportunities to grow both technically and professionally.

To complement my academic journey, I actively participated in various technology communities and student groups. I became involved in the IEEE, the Google Developer Group (GDG), and the Computer Society of Kimathi. These communities exposed me to industry trends, collaborative projects, mentorship, and peer learning. They broadened my perspective on technology and reinforced the importance of teamwork, innovation, and community in the tech world.

University life transformed me from a curious boy who loved playing computer games into a focused and determined individual pursuing a career in technology. It taught me discipline, independence, and resilience. Ultimately, it strengthened my conviction that technology is not just my field of study; it is my calling.

# Chapter 4

# Personal Life and Interests

Beyond academics and professional aspirations, my personal life is shaped by a rich mix of interests, faith, and experiences that continue to influence who I am becoming. These interests provide balance, inspiration, and a sense of identity outside the classroom.

One of my greatest passions is football. I have loved the game since I was about ten years old, which is when I began following matches on my own and understanding the beauty of the sport. I am a devoted follower of the English Premier League, and I proudly support Manchester City. Watching football has taught me about teamwork, patience, strategy, and resilience. My greatest football icon is Lionel Messi, whom I regard as the greatest of all time. His humility, consistency, and ability to let his work speak for itself resonate deeply with me; these qualities influence how I approach my own goals.

I am also an avid consumer of podcasts, which have become a major source of learning and reflection for me. They expose me to diverse perspectives on leadership, technology, faith, and personal growth. Often, they challenge me to think beyond my immediate environment.

Music plays a constant role in my daily life as well. I enjoy listening to a wide range of genres and do not restrict myself to any particular style. Whether I am walking on the road or relaxing alone, my earphones are almost always plugged in. Music helps me focus, reflect, and unwind. It has truly become a companion through different seasons of my life.

In addition to football, I have a strong appreciation for basketball. My favorite team is the Golden State Warriors, and my favorite player is Stephen Curry. I admire his discipline, work ethic, and ability to perform under pressure while remaining humble. Watching basketball has strengthened my appreciation for preparation, consistency, and teamwork.

I also enjoy traveling and exploring new places. Discovering new environments excites me and broadens my perspective. Traveling allows me to learn about people, cultures, and ways of life beyond my own, which fuels my curiosity and creativity.

Another major interest of mine is Formula One. My favorite driver is Lewis Hamilton, whom I consider my personal icon. Beyond his success on the track, I admire his discipline,

resilience, confidence, and commitment to excellence. From Lewis Hamilton, I have learned the importance of preparation, mental strength, and staying focused despite criticism or pressure. I have applied these principles in my own life, especially in academics and personal development, by staying committed to my goals and continuously striving to improve.

Spiritually, my university life marked a significant turning point. Although I was born and raised in a Christian family, joining campus helped me develop a personal relationship with God. I became actively involved in the Christian Union, where I grew in fellowship, prayer, and understanding of the Word. Through this journey, my faith became personal and deeply rooted. I now walk with strong conviction in my beliefs, having accepted Jesus Christ as my Lord and Savior. This was not just by inheritance, but by personal experience and commitment.

Like any journey of growth, my life has not been without challenges. When I first joined Form One, I struggled with homesickness and often felt out of place. Adjusting to a new environment away from home was emotionally difficult. I have also faced health-related challenges, such as developing an allergy that forced me to stop eating eggs. This required significant lifestyle adjustments.

As a young boy, I vividly remember the fear and anxiety surrounding circumcision, which is a rite of passage in my community. Though it was frightening at the time, it taught me courage and the importance of facing difficult moments head-on.

Academically, I experienced moments of discouragement, particularly in high school when my performance dropped. There were times I felt like giving up. However, through prayer, encouragement, and personal determination, I found strength in God to push forward and regain confidence in my abilities.

One personal challenge I continue to manage is being overzealous. I often want to do more than I can realistically handle at a given time. While this reflects ambition and passion, it has also taught me the importance of patience, prioritization, and trusting the process.

Overall, my personal life and interests have shaped me into a balanced individual: grounded in faith, inspired by role models, and driven by a desire to grow. These experiences continue to influence my character, guiding how I live, learn, and lead.

# Chapter 5

# Major Life Events

Throughout my life, certain experiences have stood out as defining moments that shaped my character, worldview, and sense of responsibility. These events were not always easy; however, each of them contributed to my growth by teaching me lessons about courage, resilience, culture, and faith. Among the most significant experiences in my life were my traditional initiation through circumcision and the global disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic during my high school years.

In the Abagusii community, circumcision is not merely a medical procedure. It is a deeply rooted cultural tradition that symbolizes the transition from boyhood to manhood. It is a rite of passage that prepares young boys mentally and socially for adulthood, instilling values such as courage, endurance, and responsibility.

I underwent circumcision at the age of nine years while I was still in daycare. The experience came somewhat as a surprise because I had not been mentally prepared for it. One early morning, my uncle woke me up and quietly led me to a hut where a traditional circumciser had already been called to perform the initiation. Even though I was young, I had grown up in the Abagusii culture and understood the seriousness of the moment. I knew that during circumcision, a boy is expected to show bravery and composure without crying or showing fear. It is seen as a test of courage—proof that one is ready to face life's challenges.

As I approached the moment of the procedure, I remember feeling an intense wave of fear and the urge to cry. However, I held back my tears because I knew that demonstrating strength was expected of me. Drawing courage from the cultural teachings I had grown up hearing, I stood firm and faced the knife. Looking back, that moment was my first real lesson in mental strength and self-control.

I was not alone during this initiation. I went through the process together with my cousins who were my age mates: Isaiah and Michael, also known as Mwambi, named after our grandfather. In our culture, boys of the same age group often undergo circumcision around the same period. Sharing the experience with them made the journey less lonely and created a strong bond among us.

After the circumcision, we were taken to a separate hut located at the corner of our homestead where we stayed during the healing period. According to tradition, newly circumcised boys are separated from women and girls during recovery. This period is considered a time of instruction, reflection, and preparation for adulthood. While staying in the hut, we were cared for and guided by our uncle Meshack, who acted as our mentor during this transition. He would teach us about the responsibilities expected of men in the community: respect for elders, discipline, bravery, and accountability. These teachings were meant to prepare us for our new status within society.

During the healing period, certain adjustments were necessary. Because the wound needed time to heal properly, we did not wear trousers or shorts, which was quite unusual and sometimes uncomfortable. Hygiene routines were also different from what we were used to. Despite the discomfort, we were provided with special meals and good food, as initiation is regarded as a very significant milestone in the life of a young boy.

There were also moments that were physically and emotionally challenging. One particular difficulty was sleeping at night. If a blanket accidentally touched the healing wound, the pain could be sharp enough to wake one from sleep. Another challenge was the loneliness that came from being separated from the rest of the family. At night, small sounds, such as birds landing on the iron-sheet roof or the wind rattling the structure, would sometimes feel frightening because we were isolated from the usual comfort of home.

However, after the healing period was complete and we officially transitioned into the next stage of life, there was a strong sense of pride and accomplishment. Among our peers and village friends, being circumcised was seen as an important badge of honor. It symbolized courage and maturity. We could now confidently associate with other initiated boys and were recognized within the community as young men. Looking back today, I see that this experience instilled in me a deep understanding of cultural identity, resilience, and responsibility.

Another major life event that significantly shaped my perspective was the COVID-19 pandemic, which began spreading globally in late 2019 and escalated into a worldwide crisis in 2020. The pandemic disrupted nearly every aspect of life across the globe. Health systems were overwhelmed, economies slowed down, travel was restricted, and schools were closed for extended periods. Millions of people lost their lives, and many others experienced financial hardship and uncertainty.

In Kenya, the government implemented strict measures to control the spread of the virus. These included school closures, travel restrictions, social distancing guidelines, and a nationwide dusk-to-dawn curfew which started around 7:00 p.m. Public gatherings were limited, businesses were affected, and daily life changed drastically.

At the time the pandemic reached Kenya, I was in Form Three in high school and preparing for upcoming exams. When schools were abruptly closed and students were sent home, I initially felt a sense of relief. I was not fully prepared for the exams, and the unexpected break felt like an opportunity to regroup. At first, I assumed the closure would last only a few weeks or perhaps a month before things returned to normal.

However, reality soon proved otherwise. What we thought would be a short interruption turned into nearly a full year away from school. Fortunately, our teachers had advised us to carry several books home because no one knew how long the closure would last. During the first few weeks at home, I remained disciplined. I studied regularly, worked on assignments, revised past examination papers, and continued writing notes in preparation for the future.

As time passed, however, maintaining that level of focus became increasingly difficult. With no clear timeline for when schools would reopen, motivation sometimes declined. Many students across the country experienced similar struggles, as the structure and routine of school life had suddenly disappeared.

During the lockdown period, most of our days were spent indoors at home. Movement was limited due to the curfew and health restrictions. Fortunately, my family was relatively stable during this time. My father, who works for the government, continued receiving his salary despite the widespread layoffs and salary reductions affecting many sectors of the economy. I recognize that this was a significant blessing, as many families experienced severe financial challenges during the pandemic.

Above all, I remain deeply grateful that God protected my family and extended relatives throughout the pandemic. None of us experienced serious illness related to the virus, which I consider a great blessing during such a difficult global period. Towards the end of the year, around November and December, after spending so much time indoors, we decided to visit our grandparents in the countryside. Because older people were known to be more vulnerable to COVID-19, we were extremely careful. Before greeting them, we sanitized our hands and ensured we maintained high hygiene standards. Even simple actions like handshakes were approached with caution.

That period reminded me of the importance of family, health, and gratitude. The pandemic showed the fragility of normal life and taught many of us not to take everyday moments for granted.

Both my traditional initiation and the COVID-19 pandemic were very different experiences, yet they both shaped my character profoundly. One was rooted in culture and tradition, while the other was a global crisis that affected millions of lives. From these events, I learned lessons about courage, patience, resilience, family, faith, and responsibility. These experiences have become part of my story and continue to influence the person I am becoming.

# Chapter 6

# Values, Beliefs, and Personal Philosophy

Throughout my life, the values that guide my decisions and actions have been shaped by my family upbringing, cultural background, faith, and life experiences. These values form the foundation of who I am and influence how I interact with others, approach challenges, and pursue my goals.

One of the most important values in my life is honesty. From a young age, my parents and relatives emphasized the importance of always speaking the truth. Growing up in a close-knit family environment, I learned that honesty builds trust and strengthens relationships. I always tried to be truthful with my parents, elders, and teachers, even when telling the truth was uncomfortable. Over time, this value became part of my character; I continue to uphold it in my academic work, friendships, and personal life.

Another key value that shapes my life is discipline. Discipline is essential in achieving any meaningful goal. Whether in academics, personal growth, or career development, success requires consistency and commitment. My educational journey has reinforced this lesson. I learned that talent alone is not enough: it must be supported by hard work, persistence, and the ability to remain focused even when challenges arise.

Closely connected to discipline is the value of hard work. Throughout my academic journey, from primary school to university, I have come to understand that success rarely happens overnight. It is the result of continuous effort, patience, and dedication. There were moments when my academic performance dropped or when I struggled to understand complex concepts, especially during my transition to high school. However, those experiences taught me the importance of perseverance and refusing to give up when faced with obstacles.

In my primary school education, I worked extremely hard and achieved 400 marks out of a possible 500 in the national examinations. This was a significant achievement because only about 9,000 students out of approximately 900,000 candidates nationwide were able to reach that score. This accomplishment reflected not only academic ability but also dedication and persistence in my studies. My commitment to excellence continued in high school, where I scored an A- in the KCSE examinations. This performance enabled me to qualify for and

pursue Computer Science at Dedan Kimathi University of Technology, which is a prestigious and competitive course.

My Christian faith also plays a central role in shaping my beliefs and personal philosophy. Although I was raised in a Christian family and exposed to prayer and church activities from a young age, my relationship with God became more personal during my time at university. Joining the Christian Union allowed me to grow spiritually and develop a deeper understanding of my faith. Through fellowship, prayer, and studying the Bible, I came to know God not just as a family tradition but as a personal guide in my life. My faith gives me strength during difficult moments and reminds me to remain humble and grateful. It also teaches me to treat others with kindness, respect, and compassion.

Another value that influences my life is leadership and responsibility. Throughout my education, I had opportunities to serve in leadership roles. I served as a deputy head boy in primary school, a school president in class eight, and later as a class monitor or prefect in high school. These roles taught me that leadership is not about authority; rather, it is about service, accountability, and setting a good example for others.

In addition, I believe strongly in the importance of continuous learning. Technology and the world around us are constantly evolving, and staying relevant requires curiosity and a willingness to adapt. My journey into technology, from learning computer basics as a child to studying Computer Science at university, has reinforced the idea that learning never truly ends.

Overall, the values that guide my life: honesty, discipline, hard work, faith, leadership, and continuous learning, serve as a compass that helps me navigate life’s challenges and opportunities. They remind me to remain grounded, focused, and committed to becoming a better person every day.

# Chapter 7

# Future Goals and Aspirations

As I look toward the future, I carry with me the lessons, experiences, and values that have shaped my life so far. My journey in Computer Science has not only given me technical skills but has also helped me discover my purpose and the direction I want my life to take. I strongly believe that the future belongs to those who prepare for it, and I am determined to continue growing both personally and professionally.

One of my primary goals is to build a successful career in the field of software engineering and technology. Technology has always fascinated me since childhood, and pursuing Computer Science has strengthened my passion even further. I aspire to become a highly skilled software engineer who can contribute to building innovative systems and solutions that improve people's lives. I want to be involved in projects that solve real-world problems, particularly within Africa, where technology has immense potential to transform industries such as education, finance, healthcare, and communication.

In addition to building my technical career, I also aspire to grow as an entrepreneur. My long-term vision is to create and invest in businesses that have the potential to grow into multi-million ventures. I believe entrepreneurship provides an opportunity not only to achieve personal success but also to create employment opportunities and contribute positively to society. Through dedication, strategic thinking, and continuous learning, I hope to build businesses that are sustainable, impactful, and innovative.

Beyond career and business ambitions, I also value the importance of family and personal fulfillment. In the future, I desire to build a loving and stable family. I believe that family is one of the greatest blessings in life, providing support, companionship, and purpose. I hope to create a home environment that is built on strong values, faith, love, and mutual respect.

Another personal aspiration of mine relates to my deep appreciation for cars and automotive engineering. I have always been fascinated by high-performance vehicles, their design, and the technology behind them. As a car enthusiast, one of my dreams is to one day own a high-performance luxury vehicle such as an Audi RS8. For me, this goal represents not only a love for automobiles but also a symbol of the rewards that come from hard work, discipline, and perseverance.

I also have a strong desire to travel and explore the world. Traveling allows people to experience new cultures, meet different people, and broaden their understanding of the world. Since I enjoy visiting new places and discovering different environments, I hope to travel extensively in the future. I would love to explore different countries, cities, and natural landscapes, learning from the diversity of cultures and experiences that the world has to offer.

Additionally, I plan to continue investing in personal growth and lifelong learning. The technology industry evolves rapidly, and staying relevant requires continuous improvement and adaptation. I aim to keep developing new skills, learning new technologies, and expanding my knowledge in areas such as artificial intelligence, software development, and emerging digital innovations.

Above all, I hope that my future achievements will not only benefit me personally but will also enable me to positively impact others. Whether through technology, entrepreneurship, mentorship, or service to my community, I want my life to reflect purpose, integrity, and meaningful contribution.

# Chapter 8

# Conclusion

Reflecting on my life journey so far allows me to appreciate how every stage has contributed to shaping the person I am today. From my childhood, where I was raised with love and care by my parents, to my experiences in school and university, each phase has played an important role in building my character, values, and aspirations.

Growing up as the firstborn in my family came with both blessings and responsibilities. My parents nurtured me with love and guidance; they played a significant role in laying the foundation for my discipline, determination, and strong moral values. The memories of my early childhood remain special moments that remind me of the warmth and affection within my family. For instance, I recall my father taking photographs of me using his film camera and my mother happily changing my outfits. Their playful nickname for me, "Ekegondo," meaning monkey in Ekegusii, reflected the joyful and lively nature of my youth.

My upbringing within the Abagusii community also shaped my identity and worldview. Cultural traditions such as circumcision marked important milestones in my life. These events symbolized the transition from childhood to manhood and taught me the importance of courage, discipline, and responsibility. Experiences like these strengthened my understanding of my cultural heritage and the values expected of me as I grew up.

Education has been one of the most significant pillars in my life. Throughout my academic journey, I have always strived to perform to the best of my ability. My hard work and dedication were reflected when I emerged as the top student in my school with 400 marks out of a possible 500. This was an achievement that only a small number of students in the country attained. Later, I also achieved an A- in my KCSE examinations, which enabled me to pursue my dream course in Computer Science at a reputable university. These accomplishments were not only moments of pride for me but also reminders that perseverance and commitment can lead to great opportunities.

Life has also presented unexpected challenges that tested my resilience. One of the most memorable experiences was the COVID-19 pandemic, which disrupted education systems and daily life across the world. Like many students, I had to adapt to a new reality when schools closed and learning was interrupted. Although it was initially difficult to remain

focused while studying from home, that period taught me patience, adaptability, and the importance of perseverance during uncertain times.

As I continue moving forward in life, I remain grateful for the opportunities and experiences that have shaped my journey. I recognize that success is not achieved alone; rather, it comes through the support of family, teachers, friends, and mentors who contribute to one's growth. Their encouragement and guidance have played an essential role in helping me overcome obstacles and remain focused on my goals.

Looking ahead, I remain optimistic about the future. I aspire to build a meaningful career in technology, grow as an entrepreneur, explore the world through travel, and build a fulfilling family life. I also hope to use my knowledge and skills to contribute positively to society and make a difference in the lives of others.

In conclusion, my autobiography represents not just a record of past events, but a reflection of the journey that has shaped my identity, values, and ambitions. While I have already experienced many important moments in life, I believe that my story is still unfolding. With determination, faith, and hard work, I look forward to writing the next chapters of my life and achieving the dreams that lie ahead.